

Frontech JIL-1870

Radio ga ga



Frontech's JIL-1870 was the cheapest 4.1 speaker set that made it to this comparison. In the looks department, its heavy dash of unnecessary chrome raised some eyebrows. The wooden satellites wear a classic look, with ebony-black finish and a black satin veil on the front. The sub-woofer sports a nicely brushed aluminium finish. However, a big, cheap-looking chrome plastic line around the sub-woofer port mars its looks. The chrome-finished control knobs are straight out of a classic radio. The set also comes with a built-in FM tuner. The push buttons that let you skip through stations are hard and tacky, and require quite an effort. The wires for the rear satellite are long enough, but the front satellite wires are quite short. Hook up the external wire antenna at the back of the sub-woofer for proper FM reception.

In the gaming test, the speaker performed decently with the volume at 50 per cent. When we raised it above that, distortions were clearly audible from the satellites, as well as the sub-woofer. The effects in the DVD-video test lacked spatial resolution due to its pseudo 4.1 nature. However, in the Hindi-CD audio and MP3 test, the audio quality was much better, and the response more balanced. Overall, the Frontech JIL-1870 speakers sound well till the master volume is kept below the 70 per cent mark.

Priced at Rs 1,750, they offer decent audio quality and good features. Except for the Mercury SW1980, no other 4.1 speaker set can really come close to the Frontech JIL-1870 in terms of value for money.



Price: Rs 1,750
+ Good value for money
- Distortion sets in too early

Frontech JIL-1870		A-	
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶	▶▶▶▶▶	▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶	▶▶▶▶▶	▶▶▶▶▶
Build quality	▶▶▶▶▶	▶▶▶▶▶	▶▶▶▶▶
Value for money	▶▶▶▶▶	▶▶▶▶▶	▶▶▶▶▶

// The sensitivity of these speakers is very low, so, input should be such that it will give the correct audio. They sound tinnier, i.e., the high mid-frequencies (2 to 3 KHz) are boosted. I can say the bandwidth of the audio is little better than analog telephone lines. The CD-audio sound on these speakers sound like audio is compressed at 64 Kbps. //

— NISSAR ALI CHIKATE

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